

The Happiness Trap, Chapters 24-27

My main takeaways for therapy

I value protecting and supporting my family, while not completely abandoning myself.

1. I have been in survival mode

Since my illness and operation, I do not feel like I have fully been myself. A lot of life has been about getting through, managing health, keeping things going, and trying not to fall apart.

This has made it harder to know what I want, because everything has been covered by fear, tiredness, responsibility, and background noise.

2. My values are not complicated

The things that matter most to me are:

- family and home
- peace and stability
- trust and kindness
- health without obsession
- freedom and feeling like myself again

3. I do not want life to just be survival

I want my life to feel safe, meaningful, connected, and mine again.

I want more room for gardening, gliding, home, rest, sleep, and simple enjoyment. These are not just extras. They are part of me feeling like Darren again.

4. The two blockers that stood out

"I do not know what I want" - I think this is more like fog from survival mode, not proof that I have no values. I do know the direction: family, home, peace, freedom, health without obsession, and living again.

"I will do it later" - This is probably avoidance and overwhelm, not laziness. If something feels too long, emotional, or mentally noisy, I put it off. I need small chunks, simple notes, and one doable step at a time.

5. What feels most neglected

The area I feel most out of touch with is making space for rest, hobbies, peace, and things that make me feel like myself again.

6. Some values pull against each other

Some of my values pull against each other, especially supporting others while also needing rest, peace, and a life of my own. I need help working through this so being there for everyone does not mean losing myself again.

7. What I want help with

- moving from survival mode back into living
- supporting my family without losing myself
- looking after my health without fear running everything
- keeping things small enough that I actually do them

I do not need a huge life overhaul. I need one small step at a time, starting with the area that feels most neglected.

My first step is to choose one small thing each week that is just for me, not because I have earned it, but because it matters.

Working draft for therapy discussion - simple notes, not a perfect answer.